



BUILD BLOCK BRIEF · FALL 2026-27

Applied Computing Studio **VENTURE LANE**

Planning brief session 4 · build from session 8 · 8 students · 2 teams · courses: GCCC554, GCCG562, GCCS691, GCDS552, GCCC559, GCCG566, GCDS557

What your team is building

A software product — database, HCI, graphics, visual programming, compilers — built for a real user group and launched.

ONE PROJECT, SEVERAL GRADEBOOKS

You submit **one** piece of work, and each course that marks it looks at a different dimension, out of 20. **At most eight courses mark one team file.** A course you take that falls outside those eight sets you a **lens note** instead — an individual piece on the same project from that course's angle, 3,000 words, same rubric, same 20 marks. No student carries more than two: from a third, that course marks your viva out of 30 instead.

YOUR MARKS FROM THIS PROJECT

30 the project — a team mark of 20 from each course that marks your file, plus your own viva of 10, held in class in session 14

30 the mid-term

40 the final

The three quizzes are practice and carry no marks.

This replaces coursework, not classes.

What each course marks

CODE	COURSE	WHAT THIS COURSE MARKS — 20 MARKS
GCCC554	Compiler Construction Haris Yaseen	This course marks the language layer of the product: the grammar or input specification the team defined, the scanner and parser that implement it, the checks that catch bad input before it reaches a user, and the test evidence that the layer is correct. 20 marks, team.
GCCG562	HCI & Computer Graphics Haris Yaseen	This course marks the interface: the user research behind it, the prototype and how it changed after testing, the usability test run with real participants and reported properly, the accessibility check, and the quality of anything the product renders. 20 marks, team.
GCCS691	Advanced Programming – Visual Prog Haris Yaseen	This course marks the application itself: the architecture, the quality of the code, the interface a stranger has to use without help, the tests and the version-control history, and whether the deployed product actually works when it is opened cold. 20 marks, team.



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GCDS552	Database Systems Dr Nasreen	This course marks the data layer: the conceptual model, the normalised schema and its justification, the quality and performance of the queries the product actually runs, the transaction and backup arrangements, and the handling of any personal data collected. 20 marks, team.

What to hand in

- **GCCC554 Compiler Construction** — A hosted, working application by session 12 in which this course's part — the parser, translator, rules engine or query layer — is running in production, with its grammar, test suite and AI declaration attached.
- **GCCG562 HCI & Computer Graphics** — A hosted, working interface by session 12 — the deployed product's front end, its prototype history, the usability test report naming participants, tasks and findings, and an accessibility check — filed with AI declaration.
- **GCCS691 Advanced Programming – Visual Prog** — A hosted, working application by session 12 that anyone with the link can use — with its source repository and commit history, its tests, a live deployment URL and a short architecture note — submitted with AI declaration.
- **GCDS552 Database Systems** — A hosted, working product by session 12 with a live database behind it — schema script, seed data, the five queries that matter with their execution plans, and a completed backup-and-restore run — filed with AI declaration.

How big the file is

The written file is **3,000 words for every member**, plus or minus ten per cent — 15,000 words for a team of five, 12,000 for four, 9,000 for three — plus the artefacts: the evidence or data log with its instrument, interview notes and consent log, any program with its tests, the pitch deck, the AI declaration and the draft-to-final revision log. In the venture and client lanes the live thing itself is the largest artefact. Each member owns one section of 3,000 words with their name on it, one artefact they built, and one part they can defend alone at viva. A lens note is 3,000 words on the same project. The full format is in "The Build Block File — required format" in the kit.



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Dates

Session 4	28 Sep	Planning brief issued — twenty minutes of class: the brief, the Ideas Book and the format sheet. Teams locked since session 3. Choose the project, design the instrument or find the client, split the sections.
Guest session	Session 4, 5 or 6	A practitioner from outside the university speaks to your school, on whichever of those three sessions the speaker can make. Attendance is compulsory. Each student writes one page on it for their own file; it is not marked.
Session 7	19 Oct	One-page plan uploaded to the portal: the question, the instrument or the client charter, who owns what. Not marked — it is the gate. This week the convener merges the marking courses' requirements into the file's sections, so the team writes one document and not eight. Clients matched to teams.
Session 8	2 Nov	Build starts. Rubric issued, roles confirmed, team charter uploaded. Build-with-AI workshop for venture and client teams.
Session 9	9 Nov	Scope agreed with the convener. Client or subject confirmed. Your school arranges its industrial visit for some point between now and session 12.
Session 11	23 Nov	Draft review, inside a normal class: each course teacher sees the teams in their own section for about ten minutes each — show what exists, not what you plan. The convener samples three files per block.
Session 12	30 Nov	The artefact goes live or reaches its first complete state.
Session 13	7 Dec	Final file uploaded with its AI declaration. Venture teams evidence the first paying customer. Five of the twenty come off for each week the file is late, in every course marking it, and nothing is accepted after the Karachi Review.
Session 14	14-19 Dec	Vivas in class: each course holds its own, team by team, in its session-14 class — about three minutes per student, on your own part as that course sees it.
The Karachi Review	Tue 15 Dec	Your team exhibits at its own table, across the campus, all day. The day opens with a thirty-minute handover of studies to the public bodies who asked for them; press and industry attend. Ten panels — a teacher and an alumnus each — circulate the exhibition and score you at your table, about eight minutes a team. Not marked separately; the panel sheet goes to every course marking the file.
Weekend	—	Weekend cohorts hold all of the above in their Saturday and Sunday slots; the Karachi Review runs on a weekend afternoon.

Rules for this lane



Greenwich University



A SCHOOL OF GREENWICH UNIVERSITY

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What counts as done

A live offer that a stranger could buy from, and at least one paying customer who is not a relative or a classmate, evidenced by a receipt or transaction record with the customer's identity removed.

Money

The University funds each venture team with Rs 25,000; how to draw it is announced by the Office of the Provost before Session 8. Every rupee in and out is accounted for, with receipts, in the venture file; unspent funds are returned. You may also raise sponsorship on top. The University is not a party to your venture and carries no liability for it.

Legal ground

No company is registered at this stage. You operate as a sole-proprietor offer, payments go through one team member's personal mobile wallet, and the University is not a party to your venture and carries no liability for it. You may not contract in the University's name.

Sign-off

Food, health, cosmetic and childcare offers need your course teacher's written approval before anything is offered for sale.

Marks

Your mark does not depend on how much you sell. It depends on the evidence behind the gap, the quality of what you built, what the market told you, and the honesty of your post-mortem. A venture that fails and is analysed well can earn full marks.

Using AI

You are expected to use Claude and similar tools — to research, to build, to draft, to model numbers. Three rules. Check everything a tool gives you before you use it, and record the check. Declare what you used in the AI declaration bound into the file, as the HEC *Framework on the Use of Generative AI Tools* (2026) requires. Be able to explain, at the viva, everything your team built. **Work you cannot explain is not credited to you.** Undeclared use, or use to fabricate data, references or results, is academic misconduct. Never put real client, patient or examinee data, or anything identifying a real person, into a tool.

BLOCK CONVENER

PROGRAMME HEAD

DATE ISSUED